Evaluating DRM Policy Frameworks: A Rapid Screening Tool

Evaluate a country's policy and institutional setting for Disaster Risk Management across six critical pillars

Prototype: this will be updated following test cases. Your feedback is welcomed.

Introduction

The objective of this web tool is to allow practitioners to conduct an assessment of the maturity of a country's Disaster Risk Management (DRM) system and identify the main policy gaps that may be constraining resilience-building efforts. Recognizing that a comprehensive DRM policy diagnostic requires a system-wide perspective, this tool is organized around the World Bank's DRM framework, which outlines six key DRM policy dimensions. The reader is referred to the accompanying Methodological Note for a thorough description of the DRM framework and this tool.

Legal and Institutional DRM Framework (Transversal)	
Comprehensive policy reforms that establish or strengthen the legal and institutional foundations of DRM at national and subnational levels and across sectors. ***Thematic Areas:*** *DRM Policies and Institutions | Mainstreaming DRM into National Development Plans.*	
Risk Identification	Tools and processes to understand disaster risks, which are essential for guiding risk reduction and enabling data-informed policy reforms.
Risk Reduction	Proactive policy reforms to reduce existing hazard risks, prevent new ones, and enhance disaster resilience. ***Thematic Areas:*** *Territorial and Urban Planning | Public Investment Management | Sector-Specific Risk Reduction Measures.*
Preparedness	Preparedness efforts to ensure that communities and governments are ready to act when a disaster occurs. ***Thematic Areas:*** *Early Warning Systems | Emergency Preparedness and Response | Adaptive Social Protection.*
Financial Protection	Strategies and instruments designed to reduce the financial impact of disasters on governments, businesses, and households. ***Thematic Areas:*** *Fiscal Risk | Disaster Risk Financing Strategies and Instruments.*
Resilient Reconstruction	Integration of resilience into recovery plans; prioritizing investments that reduce vulnerability.

This is a high-level assessment designed to be objective and quick. The tool assesses each DRM pillar using a set of closed Yes/No questions presented in an offline questionnaire. Users should review official documentation (legal, regulatory, institutional, and budgetary) and consult with colleagues and national authorities to provide an informed answer. This is particularly relevant for cross-cutting questions, where inputs from colleagues from sectors such as Water, Transport, Education, Health, and Agriculture may help in gathering information. Once all questions are completed, the web tool will generate key metrics and visual outputs.

Assessment Results

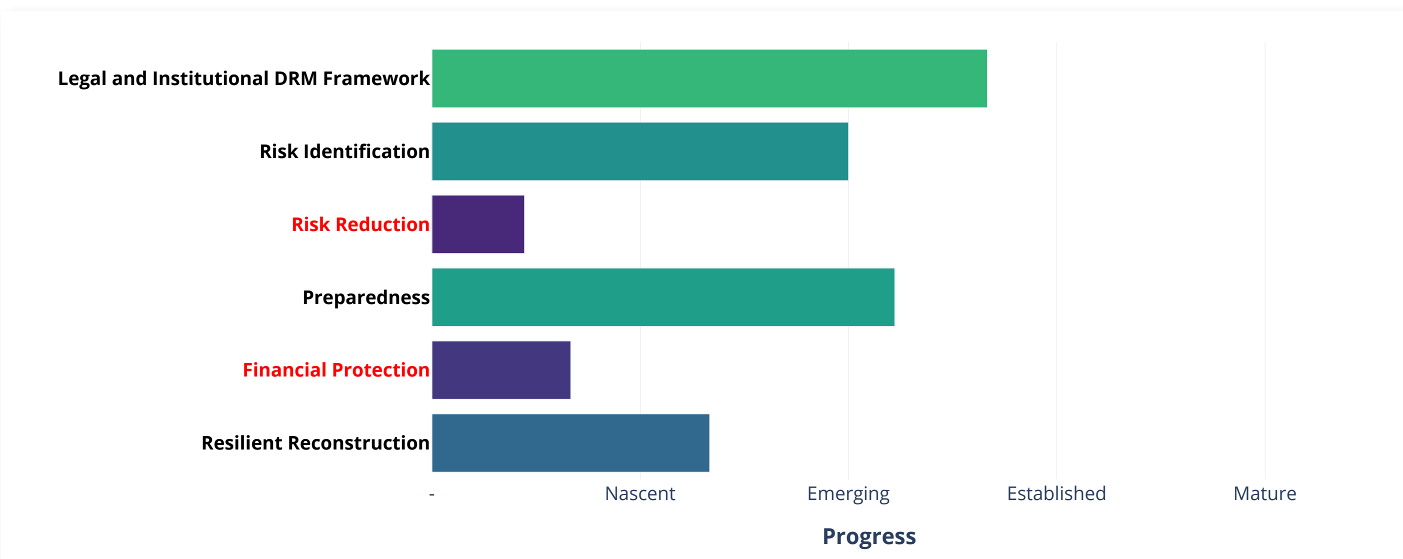
The petal diagram encapsulates the assessment results. Each petal represents a thematic area of the DRM framework, grouped by thematic area. Below the diagram, results are aggregated by DRM pillar to highlight key drivers and gaps.

- **Petal length** reflects progress in that thematic area: the longer the size of the petal, the more advanced the country is.
- **When a petal extends beyond the red circle**, minimum policy requirements for that area are considered in place.
- **Countries with mature DRM systems** typically have most petals exceeding the red circle, with some approaching the frontier (i.e., exhibiting a level of advances close to the global benchmark frontier).

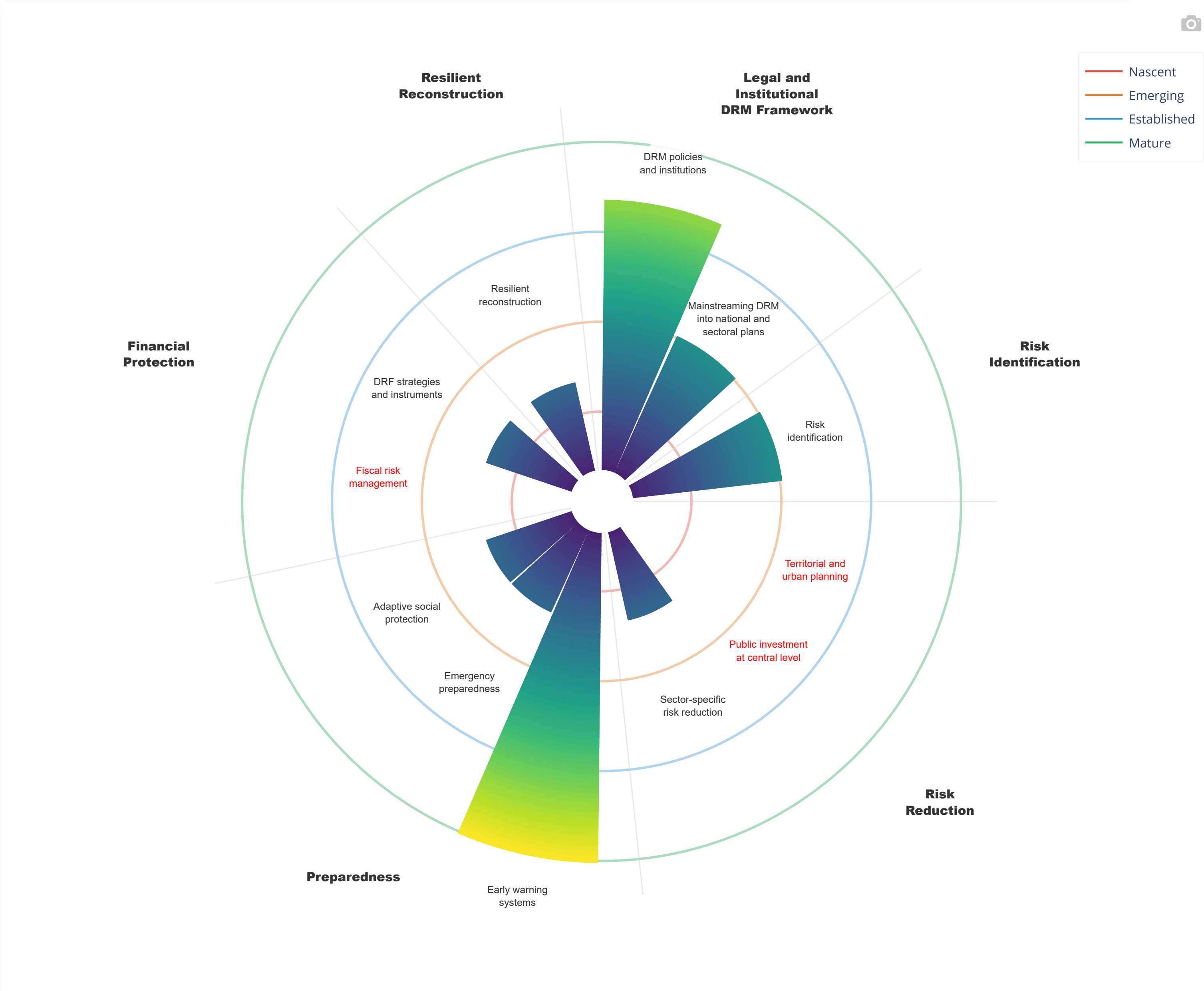
The diagnostic should be seen as a starting point for structuring a DRM policy dialogue—not as a final evaluation. Shorter petals indicate areas where the policy framework is weak and/or not producing the expected outcomes. Depending on a range of factors (e.g., political momentum, internal resources, country prioritization), this policy area may be prioritized for further support. Ultimately, this tool supports policy dialogue—whether to inform the preparation of a Cat DDO operation or to guide Technical Assistance—helping countries shift from reactive disaster response toward a proactive, strategic approach to managing disaster and climate-related risks.

While the evaluation reflects lessons learned and good practices that can serve as a foundation for a robust DRM policy framework, it should not be interpreted as prescriptive guidance. Disaster risk is highly context-specific, and this diagnostic represents only an initial step toward developing an appropriate and effective DRM policy program. Task teams are encouraged to consult the report *Driving Resilience Through Policy Reforms* for further guidance on how to structure a context-relevant DRM policy program.

Results by DRM Pillar



Results by Thematic Area



⚠️ **The following 3 areas do not meet the minimum standard:**

- Territorial and urban planning
- Public investment at the central level
- Fiscal risk management

This text was generated automatically by a Large Language Model (LLM). Users should verify the content and cross-reference with official documentation.

DRM policies and institutions

In Cameroon, the legal basis, institutional resourcing, and strategic direction are in place, enabling coordinated DRM implementation. Nonetheless, the absence of operational regulations may result in inconsistencies in roles and procedures. The architecture is strong but requires further codification.

Mainstreaming DRM into national and sectoral development plans

The national development strategy includes objectives or indicators related to DRM or climate adaptation. However, fewer than half of essential government entities have integrated these priorities into their own planning documents. This indicates a top-down commitment that has not yet been fully translated into sectoral implementation.

Risk identification

In Cameroon, institutional responsibilities are clearly defined, and essential government entities have access to hazard and risk information. Yet public access and climate change integration are missing, indicating strong governance internally but gaps in transparency and future risk considerations.

Territorial and urban planning

Territorial and urban planning instruments are developed without mandatory use of risk information, official methodologies, or guidelines for high-risk areas. Moreover, recent planning instruments have not incorporated risk data. Overall, risk-informed planning is largely absent.

Public investment at the central level

In Cameroon, there are no legal requirements, official guidelines, or mandatory risk mitigation measures for public investment projects. Disaster and climate risk are largely ignored in project appraisal, posing potential exposure to high-risk investments.

Sector-specific risk reduction measures

Hazard-resistant building codes exist, but there are no standards or guidelines for transport, education, health, or energy infrastructure. Buildings may be safer, but sectoral infrastructure remains largely unprotected. Retrofitting projects have been funded, but water and sanitation arrangements, integrated water management, watershed improvements, and sewage coverage are lacking. Some infrastructure is strengthened, but systemic water sector resilience is limited.

Early warning systems

In Cameroon, EWS institutions are coordinated, the population was promptly alerted during major disasters, and the hydrometeorological network has received budget allocations. The early warning system in Cameroon is well-functioning, coordinated, and adequately resourced.

Emergency preparedness and response

A legal framework defines EP&R roles, but national and subnational entities lack emergency protocols and gender-sensitive measures. Authority exists, but practical preparedness and inclusivity are limited.

Adaptive social protection

Support was provided during recent disasters, but there is no legal framework or unified social registry. Relief reaches people in practice, but systemic coverage and institutional foundations are weak.

Fiscal risk management

There is no institutional structure for fiscal risk management, disaster-related contingent liabilities are not quantified, key fiscal documents lack disaster risk assessments, and no stress tests have been conducted. Fiscal exposure to disasters is unmanaged and largely unknown.

DRF strategies and instruments

In Cameroon, sovereign risk financing instruments are in place, but there are no insurance regulations and no increase in financing over the past four years. Financial tools exist, but regulatory guidance and growth in resources are limited.

Resilient reconstruction

Institutions for coordinating post-disaster recovery are defined by law or regulation, but planning instruments have not been reviewed and assessment guidelines are missing. Governance exists, but operational and analytical capacity is limited.